

Gina Coburn, Ph.D.

Ventura County, CA · ginacoburn2@gmail.com · 805-626-2077 Portfolio: www.ginabeanbrand.com
· LinkedIn: linkedin.com/in/ginacoburnphd

PRODUCT DESIGNER — AI & AGENTIC EXPERIENCES · HUMAN-CENTERED AI · ACCESSIBILITY

Product and experience designer with 15+ years translating complex, high-stakes, and regulated systems into clear, trustworthy, user-centered experiences — now focused on **AI-driven, agentic, and conversational product design**. Founder and CEO of Narrative (NSF-supported), where I own product strategy end to end and have **designed and shipped a live agentic AI companion** to production. I design AI experiences around **human-centered-AI principles — trust, transparency, system feedback, and explainability** — pairing conversational/agentic patterns with traditional UI, rapidly prototyping non-linear, multi-modal flows with AI-assisted workflows, and partnering closely with engineering, data/AI, and research. Accessibility (WCAG, Section 508, UDL) is a first-class constraint in everything I ship.

CORE COMPETENCIES

AI & Agentic Product Design — Agentic and conversational UX · Proactive, in-the-moment assistance · AI-driven interaction patterns · LLM-powered product experiences · Knowledge-grounded (RAG) assistant design **Human-Centered AI (HCAI)** — Trust, transparency & explainability · System feedback & honest uncertainty states · Predictable outcomes · Ethical, non-over-promising AI **Prototyping & Craft** — Non-linear, multi-modal flow prototyping · AI-assisted prototyping · Front-end prototyping (React/Next.js) · Interaction design · Design systems & tokens **Strategy & Systems** — Product thinking · Experience & systems architecture · Complex / high-stakes / regulated systems translation · Progressive disclosure & onboarding · Roadmap definition **Collaboration & Method** — Cross-functional leadership (Product, Engineering, Data Science, Research) · Data-informed / test-and-learn · Agile · Stakeholder alignment **Accessibility** — WCAG · Section 508 · Universal Design for Learning (UDL) · Inclusive design leadership

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Narrative — Founder & CEO · 2020–Present

AI-powered platform; later supported by NSF funding. - Own end-to-end product and experience strategy — vision, roadmap, and interaction design — for an AI-powered platform, from concept through **shipped, production experiences** built with engineering. - **Designed and shipped a live agentic AI companion**: a proactive, conversational assistant that helps users in the moment across the product — defining its interaction patterns, voice, invocation/hand-off model, and the boundary between AI guidance and human-led paths. - Established the product's **human-centered-AI principles** — trust, transparency, and explainability: designed honest “pending / uncertain” states instead of false precision, **grounded AI responses in a verified**

knowledge base for accurate and trustworthy answers, and kept the system's reasoning legible so users understand *why* they see what they see. - Translated a **complex, proprietary personalization model** into a staged experience that feels like a single guided conversation — using progressive disclosure to communicate value **without exposing the underlying model**. - Prototyped **non-linear, multi-modal flows** (conversational + high-intent traditional UI) with AI-assisted workflows, then wrote them as clear, reviewable specifications engineers could build directly. - Built a reusable **design system** — patterns, tokens, dual-theme, and consistent identity signals — so a complex product reads as one coherent, scalable experience. - Partner cross-functionally with software and data/AI engineers to shape requirements, anticipate user friction, run structured QA, and ship — including deploying live services to production. - Design for a diverse, non-expert, multi-device audience with accessibility (WCAG/508/UDL) built in from the start, not bolted on.

Mt. San Antonio College — Title V Instructional Designer & Accessibility Lead · 2020–Present

- Serve as **accessibility lead** on a federally funded Title V initiative — setting reusable Section 508, WCAG, and UDL standards so accessibility scales across many contributors instead of depending on a single reviewer.
- Reframed accessibility as **design input, not a final audit** — moving it upstream into templates, defaults, and practical guidance non-specialists can apply.
- Partner with faculty coordinators and campus stakeholders to strengthen quality and scale effective, inclusive digital practices.
- Research, evaluate, and implement learning technologies that improve usability and experience quality.

E³ Center of Excellence — Curriculum Chairperson, Education Pillar · 2026

- Led curriculum strategy and experience design for the Education pillar, aligning structured experiences to organizational goals with cross-stakeholder coordination.

Florida International University — Instructional Designer · 2020–2022

- Designed hybrid and fully online experiences in Canvas with faculty and academic stakeholders; **treated scale as a design problem** — reusable scaffolds, consistent navigation, and structured review.
- Contributed to the design and launch of **1,400+ online courses** during the pandemic response while holding usability, consistency, and the accessibility floor.
- Evaluated emerging technologies and supported operational problem-solving and issue triage (Salesforce).

Green Flower Media — Instructional Designer · 2019–2020

- Built interactive courses and certificate programs (Storyline, Captivate, video) — turning subject-matter expertise into decisions, scenarios, and feedback loops rather than passive content.
- Applied **gamification and learning analytics with a test-and-learn loop** — instrumenting the experience, reading the evidence, and iterating on drop-off to improve completion and effectiveness.

Earlier Experience

Pacifica Graduate Institute — Academic Advancement Administrator; Administrative Coordinator · Independent Educational Technology Consultant · Santa Barbara Business College — Dean of Curriculum & Content Delivery; Academic Dean · College of the Canyons — Distance Learning Coordinator · Colorado Technical University Online — Associate Professor · American Intercontinental University — Senior Military Academic Counselor; Academic Counselor

TOOLS & METHODS

AI & Data: Claude · ChatGPT · LLM prompt engineering · Knowledge-grounded (RAG) assistant design · Learning analytics **Design & Prototyping:** AI-assisted prototyping (primary — rapid concept-to-working-prototype) · Front-end prototyping (Next.js / React) · Figma · Canva · Design tokens & design systems · Articulate Storyline · Adobe Captivate · Camtasia **Collaboration & Platforms:** JIRA · Confluence · Salesforce · Git / Vercel · Canvas LMS · SCORM/xAPI · Microsoft 365 **Methods:** Agentic & conversational interaction patterns · Experience architecture · User journey mapping · Accessibility reviews · Structured QA · Agile collaboration with technical teams · Translating ambiguous requirements into buildable workflows

EDUCATION

- Ph.D., Education — Instructional Design for Online Learning, Capella University
- M.S., Human Services — Criminal Justice Specialization, Capella University
- B.A., English, Aurora University

CERTIFICATION

- Universal Design for Learning (UDL) Certification